Two years later, in the spring of 2017, Maroof asked me to write a proposal for a documentary on Kashmir that he would pitch to M. K. Anand, CEO of the Times Network. He felt that the earlier three films, we made for Discovery, skirted the subject. I was sceptical of such a project. Surprisingly, in June 2017, Maroof asked me to fly down to Mumbai to meet M. K., as M. K. Anand was called by his acquaintances. M. K. stated that because Kashmir-related news generated over 45 per cent of the Gross Rating Points of the news channel Times Now, he wanted us to produce an hour-long documentary on the actual story of the state. He assured us that there would be no editorial interference. I convinced him that an hour would be insufficient to tell such a complex story and requested him to commission two one-hour-long documentaries. That way, we would be able to bring together the entire story in a cohesive manner. He was convinced. Soon thereafter, our contract was signed, and we set out on our recce in September 2017. The show we produced was called *The Story of Jammu & Kashmir.*

Another of my very close friends, Rakesh Mathur, had an extensive network of contacts in Kashmir, as he had served as the General Manager of the then Oberoi Palace Hotel in Srinagar, in the 1980s. The hotel is now called The Lalit Grand Palace. He introduced me to two former police officers, A. M. Watali and Javed Makhdoomi, who would play key roles in my documentary. Meanwhile, Dr Karan Singh and Yuvaraja Vikramaditya Singh agreed to participate in the project and allowed us to film in their homes in Srinagar, Jammu and New Delhi. My lawyer in Srinagar, Javed Iqbal Wani, introduced me to his father-in-law Mian Qayoom, who is very close to the Hurriyat. Speaking to him enabled me to explore their point of view.

We commenced filming in October 2017 and completed in January 2018. At a meeting in Mumbai in December 2017, when we screened some sequences from our film, M. K. was convinced that the story could not be told in less than six one-hour-long episodes. So, we went from one 60-minute episode to two, and then finally to six 60-minute episodes! We